

5.1 Mini-Calc typing

Types: $T ::= \text{num} \mid \text{str}$.

Typing judgement: $\Gamma \vdash e : T$ where the environment maps variables to types.

Well-formedness of sequence: e_1, e_2 requires e_1 to be either a number or a string, result type is type of e_2 .

Typing rules (ASCII inference style):

[NUM]	----- $\Gamma \vdash 1 : \text{num}$
[STR]	----- $\Gamma \vdash \text{"Uhhh"} : \text{str}$
[ADD-num]	$\Gamma \vdash e_1 : \text{num} \quad \Gamma \vdash e_2 : \text{num}$ ----- $\Gamma \vdash e_1 + e_2 : \text{num}$
[ADD-str]	$\Gamma \vdash e_1 : \text{str} \quad \Gamma \vdash e_2 : \text{str}$ ----- $\Gamma \vdash e_1 + e_2 : \text{str}$
[STR-coerce]	$\Gamma \vdash e : \text{num}$ ----- $\Gamma \vdash \text{str}(e) : \text{str}$
[ADD-mix-L]	$\Gamma \vdash e_1 : \text{num} \quad \Gamma \vdash e_2 : \text{str}$ ----- $\Gamma \vdash e_1 + e_2 : \text{str} \quad (\text{num coerced to str})$
[ADD-mix-R]	$\Gamma \vdash e_1 : \text{str} \quad \Gamma \vdash e_2 : \text{num}$ ----- $\Gamma \vdash e_1 + e_2 : \text{error} \quad (\text{disallow str + num})$
[PRINT]	$\Gamma \vdash e : \text{str}$ ----- $\Gamma \vdash \text{print}(e) : \text{num} \quad (\text{status code})$
[SEQ]	$\Gamma \vdash e_1 : T_1 \quad \Gamma \vdash e_2 : T_2$ ----- $\Gamma \vdash e_1, e_2 : T_2$

Notes:

- Only $\text{num} + \text{num}$ and $\text{str} + \text{str}$ are directly allowed; $\text{num} + \text{str}$ is allowed via coercion on the left operand. $\text{str} + \text{num}$ is rejected (no coercion from str to num).
- $\text{str}(e)$ converts numbers to strings; applying it to a string is not needed because concatenation already accepts strings.
- print consumes a string and yields a numeric status.

5.2 C++: undecidable type checking (template non-termination)

A minimal program that forces template instantiation to diverge during type checking:

```
template<int N>
struct Loop {
    using next = Loop<N + 1>;    // forces another instantiation
    using type = typename next::type;
};

int main() {
    typename Loop<0>::type x;    // triggers infinite instantiation
}
```

Compiling (g++ -std=c++17 loop.cpp) makes the compiler instantiate `Loop<0> -> Loop<1> -> ...` until it hits the instantiation-depth limit or never terminates, demonstrating that type checking reduces to an unbounded computation and is therefore undecidable in C++ templates.

5.3 Simply typed λ -calculus: can we type $x\ x$?

In STLC without recursive types, there is no context Γ and type T such that $\Gamma \vdash x\ x : T$.

Reason: to type the application we need $\Gamma \vdash x : T_1 \rightarrow T$ and $\Gamma \vdash x : T_1$ for the same variable. This forces $T_1 = T_1 \rightarrow T$, which has no finite solution in STLC's simple types. Therefore $x\ x$ is untypable unless the language is extended with recursive types or a fixpoint combinator.